



FOCUS ON... CALCIUM

This element is the most common alkaline earth metal in Earth's rocks, and the most abundant metal in the human body.



▲ Writing chalk is mainly made of a calcium sulfate mineral known as gypsum.



▲ Milk is a source of calcium and helps to strengthen our bones and teeth.



▲ The Sphinx of Giza is made from limestone, a rock formed primarily of calcium carbonate.

Calcium

20
Ca

The pure form of calcium reacts with water to make hydrogen gas and calcium hydroxide, a compound used in paper-making. The fifth most common element in Earth's crust, calcium is found in many minerals, very often as calcium carbonate. This compound appears in many forms, including calcite crystals.

ATOMIC MASS 40.078

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1808 (Sir Humphry Davy)



**Crystals of pure calcium
refined in a laboratory**

**Clear crystals of
calcite, an ore
of calcium**

